

Vanishing Creams

Introduction

Creams are defined as “a semisolid dosage form containing one or more drug substances dissolved or dispersed in a suitable base”

Creams are semi-solid emulsions of oils and water. They are of a soft consistency and lighter body than true ointment. Semisolid emulsions are of two types i.e. O/W or W/O type.

- Oil-in-water(O/W) creams which are composed of small droplets of oil dispersed in a continuous phase. They are more comfortable and cosmetically acceptable as they are less greasy and more easily washed off using water. Emulsifying agents of natural origin (bees wax, wool alcohols, wool fat). Emollient and creamy, white or translucent and stiff. E.g. Vanishing cream.
- Water in oil(W/O) creams which are composed of small droplets of water dispersed in a continuous oily phase. More difficult to handle but many drugs which are incorporated into creams are hydrophobic and will be released more readily from a W/O cream than a O/W cream. More moisturizing as they provide an oily barrier that reduces water loss from the stratum corneum, the outermost layer of the skin. e.g. Cold cream.

Cosmetic Creams

All purposes cream, baby cream, barrier cream, bleaching cream, cleansing cream, cold cream, hair cream, vanishing cream.

Medicated Creams

Medicated cream contain active pharmaceutical ingredients. e.g. Cetrimide cream used as an antiseptic. Zinc oxide cream used as astringent. Hydrocortisone cream treats rashes like poison oak or poison ivy.

Vanishing cream

Vanishing cream gets the name from the fact that it leaves no trace when rubbed into the skin. It is an emulsion of oil in water.

Constituents of Skin Creams

Skin creams consist of oils, surfactants, fatty acids, alkali agents, moisturizers, and polymers.

- While cleansing cosmetics removes oils, many cosmetic products are designed to add oily materials to the skin and hair. These ingredients cannot be applied directly because they have undesirable aesthetic characteristics in their concentrated form for this reason, cosmetic chemists create emulsions using surfactants.
- Oils give the moisturizing or light feel to the cream. Oils, such as carbohydrates, esters and higher alcohols, are the main targets of investigation. At least four oils of different melting points and polarities need to be combined. Vegetable oils and fats should be avoided as much as possible because they are prone to oxidation. To achieve a light texture,

carbohydrates that have a relatively small molecular weight and a branched-chain structure, such as squalene and liquid isoparaffin, should be used.

- Fatty acids such as stearic acid affect the form and pH of the cream and its effective components. Esters should be liquid esters that have a branched chain in the fatty acid or alcohol group, On the other hand, heavy and moisturizing creams are made by combining liquid paraffin as the carbohydrate component, an ester of relatively large molecular weight, such as cetanol and stearyl alcohol.
- Alkali agents as well as moisturizers, which are commonly glycols and saccharides, should also be selected based on the aimed sensory characteristics (either moisturizing or light).
- Polymers are essential for securing the stability of the cream. They affect the properties, external appearance, and viscosity.

For producing light and non-slippery creams, solid oils such as paraffin wax, and butyl stearate are combined with some liquid oils. Fatty acids and higher alcohols have large effects over the viscosity of the creams. To secure creams to be stable at high temperatures, saturated higher alcohols are better combined. Stearic acid also improves stability of the cream.

Vanishing Cream

Creams that spread easily & seem to disappear rapidly when rubbed on skin are termed as vanishing creams. These are an o/w type of emulsions which when applied to the skin an almost invisible layer on it so called vanishing creams. These creams can be quickly washed off with water due to the presence of emulsifiers. These creams are prepared by emulsification of stearic acid & water by means of alkalies like NaOH, KOH, borax, triethanolamine, etc. These emulsions contain potassium, ammonium or sodium stearate with water and hold emulsified form more or less free stearic acid. It also contains a hygroscopic ingredient such as glycerol and a small amount of fatty ingredient. It leaves a protective, invisible film of stearic acid on the skin. Vanishing Cream contains a wealth of natural ingredients to soften, soothe, and hydrate, leaving your skin beautifully smooth under makeup.

Formulation

1. Stearic acid. 24.0%
2. Pot. hydroxide 1.0%
3. Distilled Water 64.0%
4. Glycerine 10.5%
5. Perfume (e.g. lavender oil, peppermint oil) 0.5%
6. Preservative: Methyl Paraben

Procedure

- Potassium hydroxide is dissolved in water followed by the addition of glycerine and the mixture is heated at 70-75 °C.

- Stearic acid is melted in another vessel by heating on a water bath.
- Alkali solution is slowly added to the melted stearic acid with constant stirring.
- The obtained mixture is maintained at 40° C temperature
- Preservative Methyl Paraben and perfumes are also added to the prepared product while stirring continuously. The product is allowed to stand overnight and mixed again the next day before packing.

Ideal Properties of Vanishing Creams

- High melting point.
- Should be pure white in colour.
- Should possess a very slight Odour.
- A less amount of iodine.
- Rubbed easily on the skin without roll on effect

Uses

- Reduces loss of moisture from dry skin.
- used as adhesive for makeup powders
- Smoothens the skin and keeps it so.
- Prevents skin from roughening and chapping

